Strict dip form and groove sets

Mission: 20 strict dips, non-stop. Today: 7.

> **Today's win:** after your next pull-up groove set, do 3 strict dips with the form below. That's the whole plan in miniature.

What counts as a strict dip

1. **Top:** arms straight and locked, shoulders stacked above your hands, body straight.[1]
2. **Down:** lower under control (about 2 seconds) until you feel a slight stretch in your shoulders, roughly upper arms parallel to the floor.[1] Pick that depth and hit the same one every rep.
3. **Up:** press back to straight arms. No kicking, no bouncing out of the bottom.
4. **Torso:** stay fairly upright. A big forward lean turns it into a chest dip, a different variation.[2]

Depth is a judgement call: deeper isn't better if it hurts. Controlled and consistent beats deep.

Your two-week plan

Day	What
Mon–Fri	**Groove sets**: 3 strict dips (about half your max of 7), right after each pull-up groove set. 4–6 sets, at least an hour apart. Daily total: 12–18.
Sat	Optional: 2–3 sets if you feel fresh.
Sun	Rest.
Week 2	If 3 feels easy and fast, move to sets of 4.
Wed Oct 28	**Test** (same day as pull-ups): 2 easy reps, rest 3 minutes, one strict max set. Skip groove sets that day.

Rules for a groove set

- Practise often and fresh, never to failure: the core of greasing the groove.[3]
- Stop while every rep still moves at the same speed. Never grind.
- Any elbow or shoulder pain: stop, take 2 days off, then return with smaller sets and shallower depth.
- Missed a day? Don't make it up.

Log today

Text Gopher your sets and reps each day. They get added to the progress log.

Check yourself

1. Where does each rep start and finish?

- elbows slightly bent
- shoulders below elbows
- arms straight, locked

2. How deep should each rep go?

- same controlled depth
- as deep as possible
- just a few inches

3. Your max is 7. How big is a groove set?

- 5 reps
- 3 reps
- 7 reps

4. Your elbow twinges on rep 2. What now?

- finish the full set
- lean forward instead
- stop, rest, then reduce

Read this

Primary source: ExRx: Triceps Dip (one page, with video). Compare it with the Chest Dip to see why we stay upright.

Anything unclear? **Ask your teacher.** Message me in chat, text your daily totals, and send your test number on Oct 28.

Sources: [1] ExRx.net, Triceps Dip. [2] ExRx.net, Chest Dip. [3] Tsatsouline, "Grease the Groove for Strength" (reprint).